



Meet the real web killer: **You!**

Sensational headlines have a way of attracting your attention, don't they?

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Sensational headlines have a way of attracting your attention, don't they? You eye them with disbelief followed by skepticism but your curiosity is piqued nonetheless. After the initial gambit these articles go on to sometimes state the obvious and most often evoke ire from the reader for their flawed assumptions or factual misinterpretations. Still, they make for some very interesting reading.

In what seems like just yesterday Wired Magazine made its own sensational claim - "The Web is dead". Of course when we say yesterday it's all relative here at Digit. Yesterday can lie anywhere between the the actual yesterday to about two years ago. In this case it's more like late 2010!

So on what basis did Wired ring the web's deathknell? Wired's premise was simple - the browser is no longer the center of your digital consumption universe. Their contention is that most people access their daily dose of bits and bytes via customised experience centers called apps. So people are still using the internet (i.e the infrastructure of interconnected networks) but not the web (defined strictly as the packets of html data that go over the http protocol on port 80). To support their claim Wired had a nicely drawn graph depicting the proportions of various

types of data usage over the internet. Email, P2P, FTP, and Web traffic was shown dwindle while video was on the rise.

The trouble here was that this was data traffic - the sum total of giga and terabytes of transfers that have happened. Here is the flaw - if you were to measure the popularity of types of content, wouldn't you measure time spent? To give you an idea, if you spent the entire day reading only articles on thinkdigit.com you would probably end up using as much data as watching a lolcat video on YouTube. So to sum it up while Wired made a very pertinent observation of a growing trend, their headline claim is hyperbole.

Ok now what about our little cracker of a headline? To get to who the culprit is, we need to first figure out whether the web is indeed dead. Well, our point is that the web as you know it is dead. Kaput, poof, gone, dust! To understand why, let's delve into how the old web functioned.

Back in the day (which was not too far back) individuals such as yourself or entities like companies that needed to establish a presence online did so by owning a



you have the know how (not rocket science) you could host your own web server or you could have a web hosting service host your website for you. On this piece of digital real estate that you actually own, you could pretty much do what you wanted, barring a few laws and conventions. You can have a design that you like, deploy a software that suits you. If you don't like the service you can always pack up your data move to another host.

How did your site get traffic? The same rules of the old internet - search engines, linkbacks, real world advertising, and word of word of mouth. This model however began to change slowly over the past couple of years with the advent of social networking. With social networking came this culture of sharing. Networks started to have an unbelievable influence on the web in terms of content discovery. Facebook, Google+, Twitter all have now become continents on the web. Many upcoming businesses have begun to